

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1150

By Chism

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Reverend Jesse L. Jackson, Sr.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Reverend Jesse L. Jackson, Sr.; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Jesse Jackson was a towering leader in the fight for civil rights, voting rights, and human dignity across the United States and around the world; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Jackson was born on October 8, 1941, in Greenville, South Carolina, where his early life experiences helped shape the faith, resilience, and commitment to justice that would define his lifelong work; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Jesse Jackson's extraordinary leadership spanned three defining eras of American life—the Jim Crow period, the civil rights era, and the post-civil rights era—during which he remained a relentless and principled voice for dignity, hope, and progress; and

WHEREAS, through visionary leadership and the founding of the Rainbow PUSH Coalition, Reverend Jackson mobilized communities, expanded civic participation, and helped register and turn out voters on a scale that strengthened American democracy; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Jesse Jackson's work as an international diplomat and human rights advocate elevated the global struggle for freedom and justice, including his steadfast opposition to apartheid and his advocacy on behalf of oppressed people worldwide; and

WHEREAS, for decades, Reverend Jackson was a trusted friend to the National Black Caucus of State Legislators and a distinguished recipient of the organization's highest honor, the Nation Builder Award, recognizing a lifetime dedicated to expanding justice, strengthening democracy, and advancing opportunity for Black communities and marginalized people; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Jesse Jackson inspired generations of public servants, and for

state legislators across the nation, he embodied the unwavering belief that progress is always possible; and

WHEREAS, his enduring call to the nation, "Keep hope alive," continues to motivate leaders, communities, and future generations to pursue equity, justice, and opportunity for all; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Reverend Jesse L. Jackson, Sr., reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Reverend Jackson.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.